

when you really, really need to access it – remember, 99% uptime would mean around 90 hours of downtime a year. Whereas with your own personal cloud, you choose when it's up or down depending on your usage and need.

- ▶ And probably the biggest concerns with storing data on 3rd party servers, are security and privacy. Nothing on the internet is safe and with attacks on the rise, the cloud – with huge chunks of key data – is the primary target. The cloud storage services, no matter how big, are not fool-proof, and history bears testimony to this fact. A personal cloud however ensures so much more in terms of security, for your data is completely under your control, and who you divulge information to is entirely your responsibility.

Agreed, that despite all of this, data stored on your personal cloud isn't impregnable. There's always the risk of accident caused due to physical hardware damage caused by carelessness or natural events (flood, fire etc.), and also by not taking enough measures to protect your data against security attacks. But as consumers we tend to deem errors committed by vendors much more severe compared to our own, and therefore it seems a better option to take complete responsibility of your hardware and data rather than trust it with a 3rd party – and personal cloud software and devices give you exactly that.

So with the Personal cloud, you get to choose which data you store, delete or modify; which apps you use with this data; the set of devices that are hooked up to the PC; the different services that are accessed over your network. You define the terms of service for anybody interacting with the data, and you can do all of this using one or more trusted data interchange networks designed for it. Now wait just a second! The above definition might as well define precisely what the idea for a Personal Computer was way back in the 1970s, if only for a single device. We all know how that particular idea turned out, so odds are that the Personal Cloud might just be the next huge revolution in the tech industry. The Personal cloud is in its initial stages right now, but the future looks promising. Analysts predict that in the recent future more emphasis is going to be placed on integrating mobile technology and the cloud by increasing the number of mobile applications that access the cloud for its back-end applications. Also considering that the market amount spent on the cloud is less than 1% of the entire IT industry currently, there is almost unbounded room for growth of the cloud. So by offering to centralize people's digital lives, Personal clouds are well on their way to becoming the new PCs. 